INTERNSHIP REPORT

Submitted

For the Partial Fulfilment of the Requirement for the Degree of Bachelor of _____ with _____ (Major and Minor Subjects) under **Magadh University**

Submitted to

The Department of _____, _____ **(College Name)**

[Paste College Logo here]

Submitted by

Name : _____

Semester : _____

Programme FYUGP : _____

University's Registration No. : _____

College Roll No. : _____

Year : _____

RK NEXORA
CAMPUS TO CAREER
A Unit of RKNexora Private Limited.

INTERNSHIP REPORT

Topic - Agri Marketing

Submitted to the Head of Department, _____ (College Name), in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the Degree of _____, Magadh University

Name of Student : _____

Programme : _____

University Registration No. : _____

College Roll No. : _____

Internship Registration No. : _____

Name of the IPO / Agency : RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED

Internship Period : _____ to _____

Semester : _____

Year / Session : _____

RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED
RKNEXORA
PRIVATE LIMITED
GAYA, BIHAR - 805236, INDIA

_____ _____

Signature of Student **Seal & Signature of IPO**

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I express my sincere gratitude to RK NEXORA, RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED, _____ (College Name), my faculty mentors and the internship supervisor, _____, for their guidance and support. The structured activities, learning resources and regular feedback helped me complete this internship in Agri Marketing successfully.

I am thankful to the Head of the Department and the college mentor for their encouragement and for guiding me in preparing this report. I am also grateful to the management of RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED for providing a professional learning environment and the opportunity to learn and apply my knowledge in a practical setting. The concept sessions, hands-on tasks with sample price lists and forms, and the supervisor's patient and detailed feedback helped me understand how farm produce is priced and marketed behind the scenes.

Finally, I thank my family and peers for their constant encouragement throughout the programme.

_____
Name: _____
University Registration No. - _____

INTERNSHIP COMPLETION CERTIFICATE

The Internship Completion Certificate issued by RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED for the internship in Agri Marketing is to be attached on this page.

[Attach the original / printed copy of the QR-verified Internship Completion Certificate here]

Certificate No. _____

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PREFACE

Internships are an important part of the undergraduate programme, as they allow students to see how classroom learning is applied in real organisations. The Four-Year Undergraduate Programme (FYUGP), introduced in line with the National Education Policy 2020, gives special importance to experiential learning, skill development and employability. This report has been prepared as part of the internship requirement of Magadh University and the Higher Education guidelines applicable in Bihar.

The report describes the internship undertaken in Agri Marketing at RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED, the plan followed, the work carried out, and the learning gained. Agriculture is the main livelihood of a large part of Bihar's population, but growing a crop is only half of the story. A farmer earns a fair income only when the produce is graded, packed, stored, transported and sold at the right place, at the right time and at a good price. Many farmers still sell at harvest time to local traders at low prices, while the consumer pays much more in the city. Understanding how agricultural markets work, and how farmers can reach better markets through groups, branding, digital platforms and exports, is therefore an important skill. This internship offered a first-hand introduction to that subject.

The report has been arranged in the order suggested by the University, beginning with the cover page and acknowledgement and ending with the conclusion and attendance sheet. It is hoped that the report gives a clear and honest account of the internship experience. All examples in it use dummy data and fictitious names; no real farmer or trader information was handled.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report documents the internship completed in Agri Marketing at RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED (RK NEXORA - 'Campus to Career'). The programme required a minimum of 120 hours, completed over about four to five weeks (28 working days) with daily sessions of four to five hours, and was supported by an attendance log, supervisor guidance and review.

Background. Agricultural marketing covers all the activities that move farm produce from the farmer to the final consumer: assembling, grading, packing, storage, transport, processing, financing, price discovery and selling. India has a very large number of small farmers, and many of them have limited bargaining power, little storage and weak access to market information. Good agri marketing tries to increase the share of the consumer's rupee that reaches the farmer, reduce losses after harvest and build trust between producers and buyers. For a student from any discipline, the internship shows how marketing, economics, supply chain, communication and data analysis work together in the farm sector.

Objectives. The internship aimed to (i) build a structured understanding of agricultural market structure and the supply chain of crops, (ii) learn to study mandi prices and marketing channels, (iii) learn packaging, grading and branding of farm produce, (iv) understand Farmer Producer Organisations and export basics, (v) learn online agri marketing and consumer demand surveys, and (vi) develop communication, documentation and professional discipline.

Work carried out. The student first studied agricultural market structure and the supply chain of crops, then worked through mandi price study, marketing channels, packaging and grading, branding of farm produce, farmer producer organisations, export basics, online agri marketing and consumer demand surveys. Each topic had a concept session followed by a hands-on task using sample price lists, forms, labels and dummy data. The later part of the programme was devoted to a case study, a mock practical exercise, supervisor review and preparation of this report.

Project. The work was tied together in a project titled *Agri Produce Marketing & Price Study*, in which mandi prices, marketing channels and packaging were studied to plan a marketing approach for farm produce.

Method. A blended method was followed - learn, practise, document and review - supported by a daily attendance log with day-wise remarks and regular feedback from the supervisor.

Learning gained. The student gained a clear understanding of how farm produce is priced and moved, practical familiarity with price tables, margin and farmer-share calculation, grading and packaging plans, label drafting, survey forms and social media content plans in MS Excel and Canva, awareness of MSP, AGMARK, FSSAI, e-NAM and FPO schemes, and improved communication, observation and professional discipline.

Key observations. Farmers gain most when they sell in groups, grade and pack their produce well and know the market price before they sell; middlemen are not the only reason for low farm prices, because storage, transport, quality and information also matter; and direct and digital channels work only when quality, packaging and delivery are reliable.

Conclusion. The internship met its objectives and contributed to the student's academic understanding, employability and confidence. The report follows the University's suggestive format: cover page, acknowledgement, certificate, contents, preface, executive summary, about the agency, plan and execution, learning outcome, conclusion and attendance sheet.

ABOUT THE AGENCY

RK NEXORA, a unit of RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED, provides structured internship and skill-development programmes under the theme 'Campus to Career'. The organization focuses on academic-industry alignment, practical exposure, assessment, documentation and employability-oriented learning.

Particulars	Details
Name of Agency	RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED
Programme / Unit	RK NEXORA - Campus to Career
Registered Office	C/O Mukesh Kumar, Khiri, PS Atri, Jethiyan, Atri, Gaya - 805236, Bihar, India
CIN	U85499BR2026PTC086757
Email	rknexorapvtltd@gmail.com
Website	www.rknexora.org
Internship Topic	Agri Marketing

1. Vision

To support students in developing practical, professional and industry-relevant capabilities.

2. Mission

To deliver structured learning experiences that connect academic knowledge with workplace expectations.

3. Activities of the Agency

1. Structured internship programmes aligned with university and higher-education requirements.
2. Skill-development learning modules, practical activities and assignments.
3. Attendance tracking, supervision, assessment and documentation.
4. Employability-oriented guidance connecting campus learning to career readiness.

4. Programme Structure

The internship programme is organised around a fixed number of learning hours, completed over a defined period. Each intern is registered on the internship portal with a unique registration number, is assigned a supervisor, follows a day-wise plan and maintains an attendance log. Learning is organised into three phases: **Orientation** (Days 1-2), **Learning and Practice** (Days 3-22, ten sub-topics of two days each: one concept day and one hands-on day) and **Project and Review** (Days 23-28), followed by a concluding review.

5. Role of the Supervisor

The internship supervisor assigned by the agency guided the student through the programme, explained concepts, assigned practice tasks, reviewed the daily log and gave feedback. The supervisor also verified attendance and reviewed the student's work at the end of the programme.

PLAN AND EXECUTION

1. Objectives

The internship was planned around the following objectives, each linked to a part of the programme:

1. Understand Agri Marketing - meaning, importance, market types, participants and price formation (Week 1).
2. Learn the supply chain of crops - movement of produce from farm to consumer and the role of each intermediary (Week 1).
3. Learn mandi price study and marketing channels - rates, trends, price factors, and direct, mandi, retail and online channels (Week 2).
4. Learn packaging, grading and branding - quality standards, packing methods, labelling and positioning of farm products (Weeks 2-3).
5. Understand Farmer Producer Organisations and export basics - FPO structure and benefits, export procedures, documents and quality norms (Week 3).
6. Learn online agri marketing and consumer demand surveys - e-commerce, social media, survey design and analysis (Week 4).
7. Develop professional discipline - communication, honesty with farmers and buyers, documentation and report writing (throughout).

2. Methodology

The programme followed a blended method made up of four connected steps, repeated for each topic:

Learn. Each topic began with a concept session in which the supervisor explained the purpose of the function, its main records and how it connects with other parts of the farm-to-consumer chain. Notes were prepared in the student's own words.

Practise. The concepts were then applied in guided hands-on tasks - drawing supply chain maps, entering and charting sample mandi prices in MS Excel, comparing marketing channels, preparing grading and packaging plans, drafting brand names and labels, studying an FPO structure, listing export documents, preparing social media posts and designing a consumer survey. Only sample or dummy data were used, so that no real farmer, trader or consumer information was handled.

Document. Every day's work was recorded in the internship attendance log with a short remark, and sheets, drafts and designs were saved so that the work could be reviewed.

Review. The supervisor reviewed the work, pointed out errors and suggested improvements. Review days, a case study and a mock practical exercise helped to consolidate the learning.

3. Understanding Agri Marketing - Concepts Studied

3.1 What is agricultural marketing

Agricultural marketing is the whole set of activities involved in moving agricultural produce from the farm to the consumer. These activities are usually grouped into three kinds of functions. Physical functions include assembling, storage, transport, processing and packaging. Exchange functions are buying and selling. Facilitating functions include grading and standardisation, financing, risk bearing, market information and promotion. A farmer who sells at the farm gate performs very few of these functions and passes the rest to others; a farmer group that grades, packs and sells directly performs more of them and can keep a larger part of the price.

Agricultural produce has special features that make its marketing different from marketing a factory product. Production is seasonal while demand is spread over the year, so prices often fall at harvest and rise later. Many

products are perishable and bulky, which raises the cost of storage and transport. Quality varies with weather and with farm practices. Supply cannot be increased quickly when prices rise. Most farmers are small, scattered and have little market information. Good agri marketing tries to reduce these difficulties through storage, grading, grouping of farmers, price information and better market access.

3.2 Agri market structure and price formation

Agricultural markets are of several kinds. Primary markets are village markets, weekly haats and farm-gate sales where farmers sell directly in small quantities. Secondary or wholesale markets, commonly called mandis, are larger markets in towns where traders, commission agents and wholesalers buy produce in bulk. Terminal markets are very large markets in big cities, which supply retailers and distant markets. Markets may also be classified by the product, such as grain, vegetable, fruit and flower markets, and by the time of operation, such as daily, weekly or seasonal markets.

Many states regulate wholesale markets through Agricultural Produce Market Committees (APMC), which provide market yards, licensed traders and open auction. Bihar repealed its APMC Act in 2006, so trade in the state takes place in a variety of local and private markets, and the procurement of paddy and wheat at the Minimum Support Price is largely done through Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS). The National Agriculture Market (e-NAM), launched in 2016, is an online trading portal that links mandis across the country so that sellers and buyers can trade electronically.

The main participants in the market are farmers; village traders and aggregators who collect small lots; commission agents (arhtiyas) who help with sale and often give credit; wholesalers; retailers; processors and millers; exporters; cooperative societies and Farmer Producer Organisations; government agencies such as the Food Corporation of India (FCI) and NAFED; and consumers. Prices are formed mainly by demand and supply, through open auction or bargaining between buyer and seller. The Government also announces Minimum Support Prices (MSP) for 22 mandated crops, based on the recommendation of the Commission for Agricultural Costs and Prices, which acts as a floor price at which government agencies purchase when market prices are low, mainly for crops such as paddy and wheat.

3.3 Supply chain of crops

The supply chain of a crop is the path it follows from the field to the consumer, together with the people and activities involved at each step. A typical chain for a vegetable or fruit is: farmer, then a village trader or aggregator, then the mandi where a commission agent sells by auction, then a wholesaler, then a retailer or vendor, and finally the consumer. For grains the chain may include a miller or processor, and for exports it includes an exporter and shipping agencies. Each intermediary performs some service, such as transport, grading, storage or credit, and expects a margin to cover cost and risk.

The length of the chain, the number of times produce is handled, and the lack of cold storage and good packaging lead to post-harvest losses, especially in fruits and vegetables, and to a big difference between the price the farmer receives and the price the consumer pays. Two simple measures help to study this. The **price spread** is the retail price minus the farm price. The **farmer's share in the consumer's rupee** is the farm price divided by the retail price, multiplied by 100. A shorter chain, better handling, storage and group selling normally raise the farmer's share and reduce loss.

3.4 Mandi price study

Studying mandi prices helps farmers and traders decide when, where and how to sell. Prices are normally quoted per quintal (100 kg) as a minimum, maximum and modal price, where the modal price is the one at which most of the produce was traded. Daily arrivals (quantity brought to the market) and prices for hundreds of crops and markets are published on the Agmarknet portal of the Government of India and on the e-NAM portal, and state agriculture departments also share market information. For a price study, the daily or weekly prices of a chosen crop are entered in MS Excel and plotted as a line chart, and the average, highest and lowest prices are calculated. A moving average smooths short-term ups and downs, and comparing the same months over several years shows the seasonal pattern.

Prices depend on many factors: production and arrivals (which depend on weather, area sown and pests), demand (which rises in festivals and weddings), storage and stocks, government policy (such as MSP, stock limits, import duties and export restrictions), transport cost and fuel prices, quality of produce, prices of substitute products and international prices for traded commodities. A farmer who knows the usual seasonal rise in price may store a storable crop for a few weeks or sell in a nearby market that pays more, after deducting the extra cost. Perishable crops cannot wait, so for them the best answer is staggered sowing, processing or direct marketing.

3.5 Marketing channels

A marketing channel is the route through which produce reaches the consumer. The main channels are: farmer directly to consumer (farm gate sale, farmers' markets, door delivery and online sale); farmer to retailer to consumer; farmer to wholesaler to retailer to consumer; farmer to commission agent to wholesaler to retailer to consumer through the mandi; farmer to processor or miller; sale through a cooperative society or Farmer Producer Organisation; contract farming with a company or buyer who agrees the price and quality in advance; and exports. Newer channels include institutional buyers such as hotels, hostels and canteens, and business-to-business platforms.

The best channel depends on the product and the farmer's situation. Direct channels give a higher price but need time, quality, packaging, transport and customer handling. Mandi sale is easy and gives quick payment for large quantities, but the farmer has less control over price. Processors give a stable demand but demand specific quality. Group channels increase bargaining power. When choosing a channel, the farmer should compare the net price after all costs, the speed of payment, the risk of loss or rejection, the quantity that can be sold and the distance and cost of transport.

3.6 Packaging and grading

Grading is the sorting of produce into classes according to size, shape, colour, maturity, moisture and freedom from damage, so that buyers know what they are buying and better produce earns a better price. Standardisation means defining these grades in a fixed way. In India, quality grade standards for many agricultural products are laid down under the Agricultural Produce (Grading and Marking) Act, 1937, and products that meet them can carry the AGMARK certification mark. Processed food products are regulated by the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI).

Packaging protects produce, keeps it clean, makes handling easy and presents it to the buyer. Common materials are jute bags for grains, plastic crates for vegetables and fruits, corrugated fibreboard boxes for fruits, mesh bags, pouches for processed products and sealed bottles or jars. Good packaging for perishables needs ventilation, strength to avoid crushing and correct size for the market. Basic post-harvest steps are cleaning, sorting, drying (grains must be dried to a safe moisture level before storage), pre-cooling for perishable produce and storage in clean, dry, pest-free places. Warehouses registered with the Warehousing Development and Regulatory Authority (WDRA) can issue electronic negotiable warehouse receipts, which farmers can use to take a loan against stored produce instead of selling in distress. Packs of food products must carry the required labelling details, such as product name, net quantity, date of packing, maximum retail price and the name and address of the packer, as required by the Legal Metrology (Packaged Commodities) Rules and FSSAI labelling rules.

3.7 Branding of farm produce

A brand is the name, logo, design and promise that tell the buyer where a product comes from and what quality to expect. Farm produce is often sold as an anonymous commodity, where the price depends only on the market rate. Branding tries to make buyers recognise and trust the product, so that they are ready to pay a little more and buy again. Steps in branding are choosing a short, easy and meaningful name; designing a simple logo and colours; deciding the positioning (for example fresh, organic, traditional, premium or value for money); creating clean packaging and a clear label; and telling a believable story about the farm, the place and the people. A brand name or logo can be protected as a trademark under the Trade Marks Act, 1999.

Origin and quality marks add trust. A Geographical Indication (GI) tag, given under the Geographical Indications of Goods Act, 1999, recognises that a product has special qualities linked to its place of origin. Bihar has several GI-tagged farm products, such as Shahi Litchi of Muzaffarpur, Mithila Makhana, Jardalu Mango of Bhagalpur, Katarni rice and Magahi Paan of the Magadh region around Gaya. Organic products need proper certification before being sold as organic. A brand lasts only if quality is consistent, so branding must follow, not replace, good grading and honest packing.

3.8 Farmer Producer Organisations (FPOs)

A Farmer Producer Organisation is a group of farmers who join together to produce, buy, process and sell collectively. Most FPOs are registered as Farmer Producer Companies under the Companies Act, 2013, while some are cooperative societies or societies and trusts. Members hold shares, elect a board of directors from among themselves and appoint a chief executive and staff to run the business. The main benefits of an FPO are bargaining power through large volumes; lower cost of inputs such as seed, fertiliser and equipment through bulk purchase; sharing of transport and storage; the ability to grade, pack and brand produce; easier access to credit, training and government schemes; and direct sale to processors, retailers and exporters.

The Government of India, through the central scheme for the formation and promotion of 10,000 FPOs launched in 2020, and agencies such as SFAC, NABARD and NCDC, supports the formation of FPOs with financial help, equity grants and credit guarantee. FPOs also face challenges, such as the need for professional management, working capital, honest record keeping and regular company compliance. Success depends on member trust and active participation, a clear business plan around a few products, and quality and consistency in supply.

3.9 Export basics

Exporting farm produce can bring better prices and new markets, but it requires careful preparation. An exporter needs an Importer Exporter Code (IEC) from the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT), registration with the Agricultural and Processed Food Products Export Development Authority (APEDA) for scheduled products, a bank account for foreign payments and, in many cases, registration of farms, pack houses and processing units. The main steps are: finding a buyer and target market; agreeing the price, quantity, quality and delivery terms in a contract; grading, packing and labelling to the buyer's standards; arranging testing and certificates; customs clearance with a shipping bill; shipping; and receipt of payment.

Common export documents are the commercial invoice, packing list, bill of lading or airway bill, certificate of origin, phytosanitary certificate (issued by plant quarantine authorities to show the produce is free from pests) and, where required, quality, health or organic certificates. Delivery terms such as FOB (Free on Board) and CIF (Cost, Insurance and Freight) say who pays for freight and insurance. Importing countries check quality norms, such as limits on pesticide residue, food safety systems like HACCP and, in some cases, traceability from the farm. Risks include price and currency changes, rejection of consignments, delays and policy changes such as export restrictions, so beginners usually start with small trial shipments and a trusted export agent. Bihar's litchi, makhana, banana and maize and other products show the potential of exports from the state.

3.10 Online agri marketing

Digital platforms allow farmers and agri businesses to reach buyers beyond their local mandi. Options include e-NAM for mandi trading, e-commerce marketplaces, grocery and fresh-produce apps, the Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC), social media and messaging platforms such as WhatsApp Business, Facebook, Instagram and YouTube, and an own website or online store. Payments are accepted through UPI and other digital modes. For selling online, the product must be listed with clear photographs, grade, weight, price and delivery time; packaging must survive transport; a reliable courier or local delivery arrangement must be fixed; and customer questions and complaints must be answered quickly.

Digital promotion works through content: short videos of the farm and harvest, photographs of clean and graded produce, posts that explain the product's benefits and origin, customer reviews and festival offers. Simple measures such as reach, likes and comments, enquiries received and orders completed show what

works. Sellers of food products must have the required FSSAI registration or licence and GST registration where applicable, follow Legal Metrology and labelling rules, and respect the e-commerce rules framed under the Consumer Protection Act, 2019. Challenges are perishability, delivery cost, trust and the need for steady quality, so online sale often starts with durable products such as makhana, honey, spices and processed foods.

3.11 Consumer demand survey

A consumer demand survey collects facts about what buyers want so that production and marketing can be planned to match. The steps are: decide the purpose (for example, which pack size and price would sell best); design a short questionnaire with clear closed questions and a few open ones; choose the sample of consumers in a fair way; test the form on a few people; collect the responses with consent; enter the data in MS Excel; calculate percentages and averages; and write the findings and recommendations. Questions usually ask about the products bought, how often and where, quantity, price paid, preferred pack size, quality factors considered, willingness to pay for graded, clean or branded produce and sources of information.

Demand for farm produce depends on price, consumers' income and tastes, prices of substitutes, health awareness, festivals and seasons, convenience and trust in quality. Segmentation, which means dividing consumers into groups such as households, hostels, restaurants and sweet makers, helps in choosing the right product, price and channel for each group. Survey data protects the farmer or seller from guessing.

3.12 The marketing mix for farm produce

The classical marketing mix of Product, Price, Place and Promotion applies to farm produce with special features. The **product** is not only the crop but also its grade, freshness, pack and brand. The **price** must cover cost and give a margin while staying acceptable to the buyer, and is guided by mandi rates and MSP. **Place** means the channel and the arrangements for storage and transport, and **promotion** means how buyers learn about and trust the product, from personal contact and local advertising to social media. Adding grading, cleaning, packing and processing, which is called value addition, helps farmers earn more from the same crop.

3.13 Key measures used in agri marketing

- **Price spread** = Retail price - Farm price.
- **Farmer's share in consumer's rupee** = (Farm price / Retail price) x 100.
- **Marketing margin** = Price received by a seller - Price paid by that seller (before costs).
- **Wastage percentage** = (Quantity lost / Quantity handled) x 100.
- **Net price realisation** = Selling price - Marketing costs (transport, packing, commission, loss).
- **Gross margin percentage** = (Selling price - Cost) / Selling price x 100.
- **Repeat customer rate** = Customers who bought again / Total customers x 100.

3.14 Ethics, rules and limitations

Agri marketing deals with the livelihood of farmers and the food of consumers, so honesty is essential: correct weights, fair prices, true statements on labels, safe and clean produce and prompt payment. Important rules include the Essential Commodities Act, 1955 (which allows controls such as stock limits in special situations), the Agricultural Produce (Grading and Marking) Act, 1937, FSSAI and Legal Metrology rules, the Consumer Protection Act, 2019 and the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 for customer data. Prices, schemes, rules and export conditions change frequently, so every point must be verified from current official sources. An intern works only with sample data and does not handle any real farmer, trader or consumer information.

4. Week-wise Plan and Execution

Week	Days	Activities
Week 1	Days 1-6	Orientation and foundations: company induction, introduction to agri marketing, agri market structure, and the supply chain of crops.

Week	Days	Activities
Week 2	Days 7-12	Prices, channels and quality: mandi price study, marketing channels, and packaging and grading, each with a concept session and a hands-on task.
Week 3	Days 13-18	Brand, group and global markets: branding of farm produce, Farmer Producer Organisations, and export basics.
Week 4	Days 19-24	Digital and demand: online agri marketing, consumer demand survey, a case study exercise and a mock practical exercise.
Week 5	Days 25-28	Project closure: supervisor review and feedback, internship report drafting, presentation preparation and final review.

5. Week-wise Narrative

Week 1: The first week was devoted to orientation and foundations. After company induction, the student was introduced to agri marketing and studied the types of agricultural markets, their participants and how prices are formed. The week ended with a study of the supply chain of crops - the movement of produce from farm to consumer and the role of each intermediary - supported by supply chain drawings for sample crops.

Week 2: In the second week the study moved to mandi price study - mandi rates, price trends and factors affecting prices - followed by marketing channels, covering direct, mandi, retail and online channels for farm produce, and packaging and grading, covering grading standards, packaging methods and quality checks.

Week 3: The third week focused on branding of farm produce, including brand name, logo, labelling and positioning; Farmer Producer Organisations, including structure, functions, membership and benefits; and export basics, including procedures, documents, quality norms and target markets.

Week 4: In the fourth week the student studied online agri marketing - selling through e-commerce, social media and digital platforms - and consumer demand survey, covering the design and conduct of a survey on consumer demand and preferences. A case study exercise and a mock practical exercise were completed in this week.

Week 5: The last week was devoted to project closure: supervisor review and feedback, drafting of the internship report, preparation of a presentation and final review before submission.

6. Topic-wise Learning in Detail

6.1 Agri Market Structure and Supply Chain of Crops

Concept: Types of agricultural markets, participants and price formation; movement of crops from farm to consumer and the role of each intermediary. *Practice carried out:* Preparing a chart of market types and participants; drawing supply chain maps for a vegetable, a grain and a fruit and marking the role and margin of each step.

6.2 Mandi Price Study

Concept: Mandi rates, price trends and factors affecting prices, with sources such as Agmarknet and e-NAM. *Practice carried out:* Entering sample weekly prices of a crop in MS Excel, calculating average, highest and lowest prices, drawing a line chart and writing three observations about the trend.

6.3 Marketing Channels

Concept: Direct, mandi, retail and online channels for farm produce, and how to choose among them. *Practice carried out:* Comparing four channels for a sample crop on net price, payment time, risk and effort, and recommending the best channel for a small farmer group.

6.4 Packaging and Grading

Concept: Grading standards, packaging methods and quality checks, including AGMARK, labelling and storage. *Practice carried out:* Preparing a grading chart with size and defect limits for a sample crop; choosing suitable packaging; calculating the gain from grading using dummy quantities.

6.5 Branding of Farm Produce

Concept: Brand name, logo, labelling and positioning of farm products, with GI tags and trademarks. *Practice carried out:* Creating a sample brand name, logo and label in Canva for a Bihar farm product and writing a short brand story.

6.6 Farmer Producer Organisations and Export Basics

Concept: FPO structure, functions, membership and benefits; export procedures, documents, quality norms and target markets. *Practice carried out:* Drawing an FPO structure chart and listing its services; preparing an export document checklist and an export step flow for a sample product.

6.7 Online Agri Marketing and Consumer Demand Survey

Concept: Selling through e-commerce, social media and digital platforms; designing and conducting a survey on consumer demand and preferences. *Practice carried out:* Preparing a product listing and a week of social media posts; drafting a ten-question survey and tallying dummy responses in MS Excel.

7. Important Laws, Schemes and Good Practice - Points Studied

Several laws and schemes shape agricultural marketing. The **Minimum Support Price** system provides a floor price for 22 mandated crops, with government purchase mainly for rice and wheat. The **e-NAM** portal links mandis for online trading. The **Agricultural Produce (Grading and Marking) Act, 1937** and the **AGMARK** certification promote quality standards. The **Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006** governs food safety and labelling, and the **Legal Metrology Act, 2009** with its packaged commodities rules governs weights, measures and labelling. The **Essential Commodities Act, 1955** allows control over supply and stock of certain items in special situations. The **Geographical Indications of Goods Act, 1999** and the **Trade Marks Act, 1999** protect origin names and brands. The **Companies Act, 2013** governs Farmer Producer Companies, and the **Consumer Protection Act, 2019** protects buyers, including online buyers. Export of farm produce is supported and regulated by DGFT and APEDA.

Good practice goes beyond the law: weigh correctly, never mix poor produce with good, mention the true grade and origin, pack hygienically, pay farmers on time, keep written records of purchases and sales, and treat every farmer, trader and buyer with respect. Sustainable practices, such as reducing plastic in packing, avoiding food waste and encouraging safe use of farm chemicals, are also part of responsible marketing.

8. Process Flows Studied

Process mapping was used to understand how produce, information and money move from the farm to the buyer and who is responsible at each step. The main flows studied were:

- **Mandi sale:** Harvest and cleaning > Transport to market > Entry and weighing > Auction by commission agent > Payment after deducting charges > Produce moves to wholesaler and retailer.
- **Price study:** Select crop and market > Collect daily or weekly prices > Enter in Excel > Calculate averages and trend > Compare seasons > Decide when and where to sell.
- **Grading and packing:** Harvest > Cleaning > Sorting into grades > Weighing > Packing and labelling > Storage or dispatch > Quality check at delivery.
- **FPO marketing:** Members' produce collected > Quality check and grading > Aggregation and storage > Buyer search and price agreement > Dispatch and payment > Payment to members after expenses.
- **Export:** Buyer and contract > Quality and packing > Certificates and shipping documents > Customs clearance > Shipping > Payment realisation.

- **Online order:** Listing > Order received > Packing and labelling > Courier or local delivery > Payment confirmation > Customer feedback.

9. Worked Examples with Sample (Dummy) Data

Example A: Price spread and farmer's share (dummy figures)

A sample potato supply chain was studied. The farmer sells at Rs. 10 per kg to a village trader, who sells to a mandi commission agent at Rs. 12; the wholesaler buys at Rs. 15 and sells to a retailer at Rs. 18; and the retailer sells to the consumer at Rs. 22. The price spread is 22 - 10 = Rs. 12 per kg. The farmer's share in the consumer's rupee is 10 / 22 x 100 = about 45.5%. The wholesaler's gross margin is Rs. 3 and the retailer's is Rs. 4 per kg, from which transport, labour, shop rent and spoilage must be paid. The study showed that the margins are not unusually high; the large spread comes from several handling steps, transport and wastage, which is why shortening the chain and reducing loss matter.

Example B: Mandi price table and trend (dummy figures)

Weekly modal prices of a sample vegetable in a dummy market for eight weeks were entered in MS Excel, with the arrivals for each week:

Week	Arrivals (quintals)	Modal price (Rs. / quintal)	Observation
1	800	1,600	Harvest season starts
2	1,100	1,300	Arrivals rising, price falling
3	1,400	1,000	Lowest price, glut in market
4	1,200	1,150	Slight recovery
5	900	1,450	Arrivals fall, price rises
6	700	1,800	Festival demand
7	650	1,950	Highest price
8	700	1,850	Stable at a higher level

The average modal price is (1,600 + 1,300 + 1,000 + 1,150 + 1,450 + 1,800 + 1,950 + 1,850) / 8 = 12,100 / 8 = Rs. 1,512.5 per quintal. The pattern is clear: when arrivals went up, prices fell, and when arrivals fell and festival demand increased, prices rose. Weeks 5 to 8 show a price nearly twice the week 3 price. A group of farmers with storage or with sowing spread over time could therefore gain by not selling everything in the glut weeks.

Example C: Gain from grading (dummy figures)

A farmer has 1,000 kg of potatoes that would sell ungraded at an average of Rs. 12 per kg, giving Rs. 12,000. After sorting, 600 kg is Grade A (sold at Rs. 16), 300 kg is Grade B (Rs. 11) and 100 kg is rejected for sale as feed (Rs. 4). Revenue = 600 x 16 + 300 x 11 + 100 x 4 = 9,600 + 3,300 + 400 = Rs. 13,300. The gross gain is Rs. 1,300, or about 10.8%. If grading labour costs Rs. 300, the net gain is Rs. 1,000. The farmer also builds a name for reliable quality among buyers.

Example D: Costing a branded pack (dummy figures)

A sample 500 g pack of roasted makhana under a new brand: raw makhana Rs. 220, roasting and processing Rs. 30, pouch and packing Rs. 15, label and carton Rs. 5, transport and handling Rs. 15; total cost Rs. 285 per pack. To get a 20% gross margin on the selling price, price = 285 / 0.80 = Rs. 356.25, so the pack is priced at an MRP of Rs. 360, inclusive of all taxes. The label carries the product name, net quantity (500 g), date of packing, MRP, FSSAI licence number and the packer's address. Compared with selling plain raw makhana, the branded pack earns the seller extra margin but needs investment in packing and licences.

Example E: Benefit of selling through an FPO (dummy figures)

Individual farmers sell wheat at the farm gate at Rs. 2,200 per quintal. A sample FPO collects 500 quintals, checks quality, stores it for a few days and sells to a miller at Rs. 2,350 per quintal. The FPO's costs for transport, handling and its service fee are Rs. 60 per quintal, so the net price to members is 2,350 - 60 = Rs. 2,290 per quintal. The gain is Rs. 90 per quintal, or 90 x 500 = Rs. 45,000 for the group, besides savings from buying inputs in bulk. The example also shows the need for honest records so that every member can see how the price was calculated.

Example F: Consumer survey summary (dummy figures)

A ten-question survey was tried with 100 dummy respondents in a town. 72 buy loose produce and 28 buy packed produce. 64 said they would pay up to 10% more for clean, graded produce. 55 preferred a 1 kg pack, 30 preferred a 500 g pack and 15 wanted bigger packs. The most important quality factors named were freshness (80%), price (70%) and cleanliness (55%). Findings: start with 1 kg and 500 g packs, stress freshness and cleanliness on the label, keep the premium under 10% and offer home delivery for regular customers.

Example G: One-week social media plan (dummy)

For a sample farm product, a week of posts was planned: on Monday a photograph of the harvest with the farmer's story; Tuesday a short video showing grading and packing; Wednesday a post on the product's uses and a simple recipe; Thursday a customer review or testimonial; Friday a weekend offer with the price and order number; Saturday a behind-the-scenes post of delivery; and Sunday a quiz or poll to ask followers which pack size they prefer. Reach, likes, comments, enquiries and orders were noted each day in an Excel sheet to find the best-performing posts.

10. Project: Agri Produce Marketing & Price Study

Scope. The internship work was organised around a project in which mandi prices, marketing channels and packaging were studied to plan a marketing approach for farm produce, using sample data and templates.

Steps followed. (i) Studied the market structure and supply chain of a chosen crop; (ii) entered sample mandi prices in MS Excel, drew trend charts and noted seasonal patterns; (iii) compared marketing channels for a small farmer group; (iv) prepared a grading and packaging plan and a pack costing sheet; (v) created a sample brand name, label and social media content plan; (vi) designed a short consumer survey, tallied dummy responses, wrote the recommended marketing approach and reviewed the work with the supervisor.

Skills and tools. Market Research, Mandi Price Analysis, Branding and Packaging, FPO Basics, Digital Promotion and MS Excel.

Outputs. Supply chain map, price table and charts, channel comparison, grading and packaging plan, pack costing sheet, brand name and label, social media plan, survey form and summary, marketing approach note, and this internship report.

11. Case Study Exercise: Tomato Glut in a Village

A case study exercise was completed on a typical agri marketing problem. The village and figures are illustrative and not taken from any real place.

Background. Forty small farmers in a village grow tomato on about 30 acres. Most of them harvest in the same weeks, and nearly all sell to one local trader who comes to the village with a pick-up vehicle.

Problem observed. At the peak of harvest, the trader offered only Rs. 4 per kg, while tomato sold at about Rs. 20 per kg in the nearby town. Farmers had no crates, so produce was carried in heaps and bags and about 15% was crushed or spoiled in transport. Nobody knew the price in other markets, and the farmers feared that unsold tomatoes would rot, so they accepted the offer.

Analysis. The root causes were not only the trader. Tomato is perishable, all farmers harvested together, there was no grading, no storage or cold chain, only one buyer and no price information. The farmers acted alone and therefore had no bargaining power. The big gap between Rs. 4 and Rs. 20 included transport, loss, the trader's cost and risk, the retailer's margin and the cost of the town market, but the farmers' weak position kept their share low.

Recommendations. (1) Form a farmers' group or FPO to aggregate produce and negotiate together. (2) Use plastic crates and grading into at least two grades to reduce damage and earn more for the better grade. (3) Track daily prices of nearby mandis on Agmarknet or through the agriculture department and compare before selling. (4) Find more than one buyer, including town retailers, hotels and a processor. (5) Stagger transplanting dates in the next season so that harvest is spread over several weeks. (6) Explore simple processing of surplus, such as puree or sauce, through a local unit.

Expected result and lesson learned. These steps are expected to reduce losses, raise the price the farmers receive and reduce their dependence on one buyer. The lesson is that low farm prices have many causes, and the strongest solutions are group action, quality, information and planning of production and marketing together.

12. Mock Practical Exercise: Planning the Marketing of a Farm Product

In the mock practical exercise the student planned the marketing of a sample (dummy) farm product, for example a seasonal fruit or makhana from Bihar, from the first price check to the final recommendation. The steps followed were:

1. **Market understanding:** drew the supply chain of the product and listed the participants and the usual price at each step.
2. **Price study:** entered sample mandi prices in Excel, drew a trend chart and identified the best selling months.
3. **Channel choice:** compared direct, mandi, retail and online channels and shortlisted two.
4. **Grading and packaging:** prepared a grading chart, selected the pack and calculated the cost per pack.
5. **Branding:** created a brand name, logo and label with legal information and a short brand story.
6. **Group and export options:** listed how an FPO could help and which export documents would be needed.
7. **Digital promotion and survey:** prepared a product listing, a week of posts and a short consumer survey with dummy results.
8. **Recommendation:** wrote a one-page marketing approach with target buyers, price, channel, packaging, promotion plan and risks.

The exercise showed that every step depends on the one before it: wrong price information leads to a wrong channel choice, weak grading hurts the brand, and a plan without buyer research may not match what customers want.

13. Sample Checklists Prepared

Checklists were prepared as part of the hands-on tasks. They reduce errors and make routine work easier to review.

Mandi Price Study Checklist

- Crop, market and period selected.
- Prices collected from an official source such as Agmarknet or e-NAM with date and unit (per quintal).
- Minimum, modal and maximum prices and arrivals recorded.
- Average, highest and lowest prices calculated and a line chart drawn.
- Seasonal pattern, festivals and policy events noted.
- Transport and other costs to alternative markets estimated.
- Conclusion on when and where to sell written.

Grading and Packaging Checklist

- Produce cleaned and dried or cooled as needed.
- Grades defined by size, colour, maturity and defects.
- Grade-wise weight recorded and rejects separated.
- Packaging material suited to the product and the distance.
- Label with name, grade, net quantity, date of packing, MRP and packer details.
- FSSAI or AGMARK requirements checked where applicable.
- Storage place clean, dry, ventilated and pest-free.

FPO Formation and Working Checklist

- Group of interested farmers and common crops identified.
- Legal form chosen (producer company, cooperative or society) and name selected.
- Members enrolled, shares allotted and board elected.
- Business plan with two or three products, costs and targets made.
- Bank account, PAN and required registrations obtained.
- Records of members, purchase, sales and meetings maintained.
- Annual compliance, audit and member meeting planned.

Export Readiness Checklist

- IEC from DGFT and APEDA registration (where applicable) obtained.
- Buyer, target country and import rules checked.
- Quality norms such as residue limits and food safety needs met.
- Grading, packing and labelling as per buyer's requirement.
- Commercial invoice, packing list and phytosanitary and origin certificates ready.
- Shipping, insurance and delivery terms (FOB or CIF) agreed.
- Payment terms and risk of rejection or delay considered.

Online Selling and Consumer Survey Checklist

- Product photographs, grade, weight, price and delivery time listed clearly.
- FSSAI, GST and labelling requirements checked.
- Packaging tested for transport and a delivery partner fixed.
- Quick replies, reviews and complaint handling planned.

- Survey purpose, sample and questions fixed; form tested on a few persons.
- Consent taken, data entered in Excel and personal data kept safe.
- Findings turned into clear recommendations on product, pack, price and promotion.

14. Tools and Resources

Learning materials, sample price lists from Agmarknet and e-NAM, sample forms and labels, MS Excel for price tables, charts and costing, MS Word and PowerPoint for documentation and presentation, Canva for logos, labels and social media posts, APEDA, DGFT, FSSAI and FPO scheme reference material, assignments and mentor feedback were used during the internship.

15. Programme at a Glance

The programme was in the domain of Agri Marketing with RKNEXORA PRIVATE LIMITED as the agency. It required a minimum of 120 hours over 28 learning days, organised in three phases: Orientation (Days 1-2), Learning and Practice (Days 3-22) and Project and Review (Days 23-28). Attendance was recorded in the Internship Attendance Log, signed by the supervisor (see Attendance Sheet).

LEARNING OUTCOME

a. Knowledge Acquired

1. Meaning of agricultural marketing, the types of agricultural markets, their participants and how prices are formed, including MSP and e-NAM.
2. The supply chain of crops, the role of each intermediary, and how to measure price spread and farmer's share.
3. How to study mandi prices from official sources and understand seasonal patterns and the factors that move prices.
4. The main marketing channels for farm produce and how to choose among them.
5. Grading, packaging, labelling and storage, including AGMARK, FSSAI and warehouse receipts.
6. Branding of farm produce, including GI tags and trademarks, the structure and benefits of Farmer Producer Organisations and export basics.
7. Online agri marketing, consumer demand surveys and the marketing mix for farm produce.

Glossary of Terms Learned

- **Agri marketing** - All activities that move farm produce from the farmer to the consumer.
- **Mandi** - Wholesale market where agricultural produce is bought and sold in bulk.
- **APMC** - Agricultural Produce Market Committee that regulates wholesale markets in many states.
- **e-NAM** - National Agriculture Market, an online trading portal linking mandis.
- **Arhtiya** - Commission agent who helps farmers sell produce in the mandi.
- **MSP** - Minimum Support Price announced by the Government for 22 mandated crops.
- **Modal price** - The price at which most of the produce was traded in a market.
- **Quintal** - Unit of weight equal to 100 kg.
- **Price spread** - Difference between consumer price and farm price.
- **Farmer's share** - Farm price as a percentage of the consumer's price.
- **Post-harvest loss** - Loss of quantity or quality of produce after harvest.
- **Grading** - Sorting of produce into quality classes.
- **AGMARK** - Certification mark for the quality of agricultural products.
- **GI tag** - Geographical Indication showing a product's special link with its place of origin.
- **FPO / FPC** - Farmer Producer Organisation / Company owned by farmer members.
- **WDRA / e-NWR** - Warehousing regulator / electronic negotiable warehouse receipt.
- **IEC** - Importer Exporter Code required to export.
- **APEDA** - Authority that promotes export of agricultural and processed food products.
- **Phytosanitary certificate** - Certificate showing that plant produce is free from pests.
- **ONDC** - Open Network for Digital Commerce, an open e-commerce network.

b. Skills Learned

Technical skills. Collecting and charting mandi prices in MS Excel; calculating price spread, farmer's share, wastage and pack cost; comparing marketing channels; preparing grading and packaging plans; designing a brand name, logo and label in Canva; drafting export document lists; preparing social media content plans; and designing and tallying a consumer survey.

Professional skills. Clear communication with farmers and buyers; observation and market awareness; analytical and problem-solving thinking; honesty and fair dealing; creativity in branding and promotion; time management and teamwork; and documentation, report writing and presentation.

These skills were developed through repeated practice and daily documentation. Working with price data improved analytical thinking, costing exercises improved accuracy, branding tasks improved creativity, and writing remarks and reports improved communication.

c. Observed Attitude and Gained Values

1. Respect for the farmer: the farmer's hard work and risk deserve a fair price and honest dealing.
2. Honesty and fairness in trade: weights, grades and labels must be true.
3. Data-based thinking: decisions about price and channel should be based on facts, not guesses.
4. Discipline and punctuality: regular reporting at fixed timings and daily attendance records.
5. Cooperation: farmers, traders and buyers do better when they work together and trust each other.

d. Challenges Faced

Understanding market terms such as modal price, arrivals, arhtiya, GI tag and phytosanitary certificate was handled by using a glossary, reference material and mentor guidance.

Reading and interpreting price data was difficult at first because prices vary by day and market; this was handled by using weekly averages, charts and the supervisor's guidance.

Working without real field data was handled by using official sample data, dummy figures and clear assumptions that were written beside each calculation.

Designing a label that follows rules was handled by using a checklist of mandatory label details and reviewing the draft with the supervisor.

Maintaining consistent documentation was handled by using daily log entries and reviewing feedback to improve documentation progressively.

Managing time between practice, documentation and report writing was handled by dividing work week by week and using review days for corrections.

e. Career Pathways

The knowledge gained supports further study and careers such as Marketing Executive in agri-input and agri-output companies, FPO Manager or Business Development Executive, Market Analyst or Commodity Research Assistant, Supply Chain or Procurement Executive for food and agri companies, Agri E-commerce Executive, Export Executive for agricultural products, Rural Marketing Officer and Field Officer with development agencies. Opportunities exist in FPOs, cooperatives, food processing and retail companies, agri-startups, banks and development agencies, state and central agriculture programmes and agri-export firms. Related higher-study options include MBA in Agri-Business Management or Rural Management, Master's programmes in Agricultural Economics or Marketing, and certificate courses offered by agricultural universities, NABARD, SFAC, APEDA and other institutions.

CONCLUSION

The internship in Agri Marketing was a valuable learning experience that integrated academic knowledge with practical activity. The programme achieved its objectives through structured learning, guided practice, assignments, supervisor review and documentation.

The student gained a clear understanding of how farm produce reaches the consumer - through market structure, the crop supply chain, mandi prices, marketing channels, packaging and grading, branding, FPOs, export basics, online marketing and consumer demand surveys - and acquired practical familiarity with price charts, margin and farmer-share calculations, grading and packaging plans, labels and survey sheets. The experience has strengthened the student's employability and provides a foundation for further study and work in agri-business, rural marketing and food supply chains.

Reflection

Looking back, the most useful lesson of the internship was that a farmer's income depends not only on how much is grown but on how, when and where it is sold. Small steps such as grading, better packing, knowing the market price, selling in a group and telling the story of the product can make a real difference. Moving from concept to practice to documentation made abstract ideas concrete, and supervisor feedback showed where understanding was weak. The habit of recording each day's work also made it easier to see progress over the weeks.

Objectives and Achievement

The objective of understanding agri market structure and the supply chain was achieved through concept sessions, a chart of market types and supply chain maps for sample crops. The objective of learning mandi prices and marketing channels was achieved by preparing price tables and charts in Excel and comparing channels for a farmer group. The objective of learning packaging, grading and branding was achieved through a grading plan, pack costing sheet and a sample brand and label. The objective of understanding FPOs and exports was achieved through an FPO structure chart and an export document checklist. The objective of learning online marketing and consumer surveys was achieved through a product listing, a social media plan and a survey with dummy results. The objective of developing professional discipline was achieved through daily attendance, supervisor review and report writing.

Future Scope

The knowledge gained can support further study of agri-business and rural marketing, and careers in FPOs, agri companies, food processing, retail, e-commerce, export firms and development agencies. With growing interest in branded and GI-tagged farm products, digital platforms, food processing and exports, trained marketing professionals who understand farmers and markets are increasingly needed, including in Bihar.

Suggestions for Improvement of the Programme

1. Include visits to a mandi, a warehouse or an FPO, and talks by farmers and traders, with appropriate permissions.
2. Continue regular mentor feedback and progress reviews.
3. Provide more project-based activities such as a live price study of a local crop over several weeks.
4. Encourage students to maintain detailed daily documentation.

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ATTENDANCE SHEET

The Internship Attendance Log issued by the IPO, with the supervisor's signature for each day, is to be attached on this page.

[Attach the signed Internship Attendance Log here]